Gallery Gestalt

An art-making game for 1 to 9 players

Play as artists in a unique world, making masterpieces to respond to the momentous times around them.

Setup

Before you start playing, gather the following:

- **Inspiration Cards** (or a standard deck of playing cards)
- A stack of paper for drawing
- Art supplies, like colored pencils, markers, pastels, and more!

Give each player two pieces of paper. Label one paper "**Artist**" and the other "**Artwork**". This is where you will make up your own artist and their masterpiece!

Get one piece of paper, put it somewhere everyone can see, and label it "**Story**". We'll start the game by learning about where our artists live, and what's going on in their world!

Inspiration Cards

Shuffle the **Inspiration Cards**, draw one, and show everyone. Each **Inspiration Card** has a **Prompt**, **Shape**, color, suit and rank. Through this game, we'll be using these cards to inspire our drawings!

If you're using a standard deck of playing cards, refer to the **Inspiration Table** on the following page to determine the attributes on each card.

Ask the Cards

Throughout this game, we'll use the **Inspiration Cards** to give us ideas for our art and our story. When the rules say to **Ask the Cards** a question, do the following:

1. Draw five cards
2. Select three **Prompts** that work together to inspire an answer
3. Write down the chosen **Prompts**
4. Shuffle cards back into the deck (sometimes we hang on to some)

Where are we?

The player who most recently went to a museum **Asks the Cards** the following question, writing on the **Story** sheet.

- What sort of world do we live in: is it like our own world, or is it a fantastical place?

Work as a group using the selected prompts to inspire answers, each player gets a say. Don't shuffle the selected cards back into the deck when you're done—we'll use them at the end!

Who is my artist?

We'll on take the roles of artists in this world. Let's learn who we are! Each player **Asks the Cards** the following question writing on their **Artist** sheet.

- Who's this artist: what's my art style and what's my personality like?

Take a few minutes to sketch your artist on the **Artist** sheet. When you're finished, give them a name, and share them with the group! Shuffle the cards back into the deck.

What's going on?

The player to the left of the first **Asks the Cards** the above question, writing on the **Story** sheet.

- Something big just happened in our world: is it good, bad, or strange and confusing?

Work as a group using the selected prompts to inspire answers, each player gets a say. Don't shuffle the selected cards back into the deck when you're done—we'll use them at the end!

What will I make?

Now that we have set the stage, we're going to learn what we'll make. Everyone draw five cards, pick two to keep, and three to pass to the player to your left. (Solo Play: keep cards)

With your new hand of five, each player **Asks the Cards** the following question writing on the back of your **Artist** sheet

- What will I create? How will you respond to the big happening in our world with art, in your unique style?

Keep the three selected cards, we'll use them later! Before discarding the cards you did not keep write their **Shapes** next to the selected **Prompts**. Once all players have discarded shuffle the deck.

Time for art!

Now that our canvas is ready, it's time to start your masterpiece! Grab the Artwork sheet and begin working on your art. Use the back of your **Artist** sheet to guide your piece, let the **Prompts** inspire you and try to included the **Shapes**.

We'll be drawing for ten minutes and then taking a break and adding some new **Inspiration Cards** to the mix! This process will happen four times. At the end of the last art session, it's time to share at the gallery!

Gather inspiration

After ten minutes, we'll mix it up!

- Take moment to stretch, chat, and share your art.
- Then, each player draws one **Inspiration Card** from the deck to add to their hand of three.
- Choose one of those four cards and give it to the player to the left. (Solo play: keep card)

Write the **Prompt** of the card you recieved on the back of your **Artist** sheet. Use this **Prompt** to inspire answers to the following question.

- How is this inspiration influencing me: is it a boon, a challenge to overcome, or a mystery to solve?

Discard a card from your hand. Write its **Prompt** and **Shape** on the back of your **Artist** profile. Use this **Prompt** to inspire answers to the following question.

- How do I react to this influence: do I come out for better, worse, or does something new happen?

Write the answers to these questions on the back of your artist profile. Once all players have finished and shared what happened to their artist begin the next round of drawing.

Share at the gallery

Take the six cards we used to answer **Where Are We** and **What's Going On**, shuffle them together. Draw one card from this new deck, write its **Prompt** on the **Story** sheet. Work as a group using this **Prompt** to answer the following question.

- How has our story concluded? What's going on with our world and the big happening?

Time to show your work off. Organize the art as if it were in a gallery, and take some time to explore. Present your art to your fellow artists, discuss how you responded to the big happening with your art, and which inspirations you took to heart.

Finally nominate the artwork that best captures the **Prompt** which inspired your conclusion. This is the masterpiece of the gallery.

WHERE ARE WE?
WHO IS MY ARTIST?
WHAT'S GOING ON?

When using this table to look up cards during these steps, write all 5 **Prompts** where directed. Circle the selected **Prompts** and cross out the unselected ones.

WHAT WILL I MAKE?
GATHER INSPIRATION

When using this table to look up cards during these steps, write the suit, value, **Prompt** and **Shape** in a row where directed. Circle the **Prompts** you choose for your inspiration and the **Shapes** of the cards you discard. When you discard or pass cards to other players cross out all uncircled parts of that card.



K ♢ Hold	Q ♢ Crowd	J ♢ Trade	10 ♢ Union	9 ♢ Treasure	8 ♢ Law	7 ♢ Fall	6 ♢ Order	5 ♢ Crown	4 ♢ Break	3 ♢ Tower	2 ♢ Guard	A ♢ Cloak
K ♡ Ruin	Q ♡ Space	J ♡ Grave	10 ♡ Wild	9 ♡ Heart	8 ♡ Gift	7 ♡ Star	6 ♡ Well	5 ♡ Shadow	4 ♡ Tear	3 ♡ Band	2 ♡ Light	A ♡ Fire
K ♣ Shelter	Q ♣ Sprout	J ♣ Craft	10 ♣ Dance	9 ♣ Desert	8 ♣ Hand	7 ♣ Land	6 ♣ Strike	5 ♣ Fruit	4 ♣ Beast	3 ♣ Pain	2 ♣ Blood	A ♣ Scale
K ♠ Shock	Q ♠ Bridge	J ♠ Figure	10 ♠ Guide	9 ♠ Charm	8 ♠ Artifact	7 ♠ Watch	6 ♠ Track	5 ♠ Journey	4 ♠ Spark	3 ♠ Secret	2 ♠ Cloud	A ♠ Dream

WHERE ARE WE?
WHO IS MY ARTIST?
WHAT'S GOING ON?

When using this table to look up cards during these steps, write all 5 words where directed. Circle the selected words and cross out the unselected ones.

WHAT WILL I MAKE?
GATHER INSPIRATION

When using this table to look up cards during these steps, write the suit, value, word and shape in a row under the commission title. Circle the words you choose for your commission and the shapes of the cards you discard. When you discard or pass cards to other players cross out all uncircled parts of that card.

